

KIRAN KUMAR PUNATI

SENIOR INFRASTRUCTURE ENGINEER

Linux & UNIX Infrastructure | VMware | AIX | Cloud Infrastructure | Automation | Enterprise Operations | India

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior Systems / Infrastructure Engineer with 6 years of enterprise infrastructure experience across Linux/UNIX administration, VMware virtualization, AIX, data center operations, cloud infrastructure, automation, monitoring, patching, security hardening, backup/recovery and disaster recovery. Currently supporting global infrastructure at GTT Communications, managing KVM/Apache CloudStack environments across RHEL, Rocky Linux and Ubuntu, with Python/API automation, NetBox integration, Zabbix self-healing and Dell iDRAC/Active Directory access management. Previously supported large-scale VMware environments of up to 1,000 virtual servers and 500 physical servers, plus Nutanix, Cisco UCS/Intersight, SAN, AIX 7.2/7.3 and IBM Spectrum Scale/GPFS. Strong in production troubleshooting, infrastructure lifecycle management, OS upgrades, security compliance, incident/change management and DR. Targeting Senior Systems Engineer, Infrastructure Engineer, Linux Engineer, Virtualization Engineer and Cloud Infrastructure Engineer opportunities.

CORE TECHNICAL SKILLS

Linux / UNIX	RHEL 5–9, Rocky Linux 9, Ubuntu Server 22.04/24.04, CentOS, SUSE, Oracle Enterprise Linux, AIX 7.2/7.3, Solaris
Virtualization	VMware vSphere, ESXi 6.x/7.x, vCenter, vMotion, Storage vMotion, HA, DRS, Storage DRS, KVM/QEMU, Nutanix/Prism
Cloud / Infrastructure	Apache CloudStack, Microsoft Azure, Terraform, NetBox SSoT, Dell iDRAC, Cisco UCS, Cisco Intersight, Cisco UCS Central
Automation	BigFix automation, Python, Bash/Shell, Cron, REST APIs, systemd service automation
Monitoring	Zabbix, Splunk, Nagios, Zenoss, custom alert/error parsers, vCenter Operations Manager
Storage / Backup	Commvault, Veritas NetBackup, Networker, VMware snapshots, SAN, iSCSI, MPIO, LVM, MMFS/IBM Spectrum Scale/GPFS
Network / Services	TCP/IP, LAN/WAN, VLANs, Virtual Distributed Switches, DNS, DHCP, HTTP, SSH, FTP, NFS, Samba, SMTP
Security / Operations	Active Directory, RBAC, sudo, CyberArk, CIS hardening, SSH keys, password policy, vulnerability/patch management
Enterprise Operations	Incident Management, Change Management, RCA, SOPs, Knowledge Articles, DR drills, data center migrations, vendor management

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

GTT Communications | Senior Systems Engineer | Jan 2026 – Present

Kiran Kumar Punati | Senior Infrastructure Engineer

- Manage global KVM host clusters and Apache CloudStack environments across RHEL 8, Rocky Linux 9 and Ubuntu Server 22.04/24.04, maintaining reliable production infrastructure across global data centers.
- Develop Python and REST API automation to synchronize live CloudStack VM/host inventory with NetBox, enforcing metadata standards and automated journal logging as a single source of truth.
- Engineer scheduled Cron/Python infrastructure audits and baseline checks across regional clusters to detect configuration drift and improve operational consistency.
- Design Zabbix-based self-healing workflows with tightly scoped sudo privileges to automatically detect and remediate failed services such as SSSD and Postfix.
- Integrate Dell iDRAC with Active Directory and implement centralized least-privilege RBAC for out-of-band infrastructure administration.
- Execute enterprise Linux kernel/OS patching, upgrades and post-change validation across RHEL and Ubuntu media servers supporting Veritas NetBackup.
- Built custom NetBackup/Zabbix error parsing and notification automation to convert complex backup failures into actionable operational alerts.
- Created standardized SOPs, operational playbooks and VM deployment templates for infrastructure and development teams.
- Demonstrated strong hands-on expertise in **ServiceNow ITSM**, managing incidents, service requests, ticket lifecycle, troubleshooting, and resolution workflows.
- Developing knowledge of **Terraform**, with an understanding of **Infrastructure as Code (IaC)** concepts and its application in infrastructure provisioning and management.
- Hands-on experience working with **Microsoft Azure and Hybrid Cloud environments**, supporting infrastructure across cloud and on-premises platforms.
- Hands-on experience in **SAN storage operations**, including **WWPN scanning, LUN assignment, Fibre Channel configuration, and Soft and Hard Zoning**.
- Hands-on experience developing and configuring **Ansible playbooks for infrastructure automation**, leveraging **AI-assisted tools** to support playbook development, troubleshooting, and optimization.

Virtusa | Senior Software Engineer – Infrastructure | Aug 2024 – Jan 2026

- Administered enterprise RHEL environments, performing security patching through BigFix, OS troubleshooting, compliance remediation and RHEL 7-to-8 in-place upgrades with pre/post validation.
- Managed VMware vSphere/ESXi infrastructure, including HA, DRS, Storage DRS, vMotion, Storage vMotion, ESXi patching, vCenter operations, VMs, SAN/iSCSI and virtual networking.
- Integrated newly built physical and virtual servers into the **Commvault** backup infrastructure, configuring subclients, storage policies, and schedules.
- Executed proper server decommissioning workflows by safely cleaning up client associations, retention policies, and storage configurations in **Commvault**.
- Handled end-to-end data recovery operations using the **Commvault** UI to restore critical system states, databases, and user files upon request.
- Supported large-scale virtual infrastructure of up to 1,000 virtual servers and 500 physical servers, maintaining availability, resource utilization and operational stability.
- Executed VM provisioning, CPU/memory/storage changes, P2V/V2V conversions, backup/restore, host configuration backup and data center migration activities.
- Administered Nutanix/Prism environments for high availability, capacity management, performance monitoring and lifecycle updates.
- Managed Cisco Intersight and Cisco UCS Central for centralized compute infrastructure management, policy enforcement and hardware operations.
- Administered AIX 7.2/7.3 infrastructure, including OS upgrades, LVM/file-system management, MMFS/GPFS expansion, MPIO migrations and Live Partition Mobility.

- Performed production OS, kernel, network, hardware and performance troubleshooting; coordinated complex issues with Red Hat, IBM, Cisco and Broadcom vendor support teams.
- Managed temporary/permanent sudo access, decommissioning of end-of-life systems, enterprise documentation, RCA, SOPs and knowledge articles.
- Participated in disaster recovery drills and production data center migration initiatives, including planning, testing and execution.
- Demonstrated strong hands-on expertise in **ServiceNow ITSM**, managing incidents, service requests, ticket lifecycle, troubleshooting, and resolution workflows.

HCL Technologies Ltd. – Sempra Energy Account | Technical Specialist – Infrastructure | May 2021 – Jun 2024

- Administered Linux/UNIX servers, including installation, provisioning, patching, backup/recovery, file systems, users/groups, LVM and production troubleshooting.
- Performed RHEL 7/8, OEL 7/8, Debian 11 and Solaris security hardening and CIS benchmark implementation, including sudo policies, password controls, SSH keys and port/security checks.
- Managed package and patch administration using YUM/RPM, Red Hat Satellite, Spacewalk, local repositories and Kickstart-based server deployment.
- Supported VMware vSphere environments, server commissioning/decommissioning, VM deployment, and enterprise infrastructure lifecycle activities.
- Configured and maintained Apache, Oracle, MySQL, NFS, DHCP, SSH and DNS services in enterprise Linux environments.
- Supported Oracle cluster disk configurations using ASM/RDM and performed hardware break-fix support across HP, Dell and IBM infrastructure.
- Participated in data center migrations, LAN/ACI fabric upgrades, DR site implementation and infrastructure change activities.
- Created technical KBs and Confluence documentation covering server commissioning/decommissioning, Java installation/upgrades, CyberArk troubleshooting and RSA administration.
- Supported incident and change management and executed LEAPP-based OS upgrades for OEL/RHEL environments.
- Demonstrated strong hands-on expertise in **ServiceNow ITSM**, managing incidents, service requests, ticket lifecycle, troubleshooting, and resolution workflows.

CERTIFICATIONS

- Red Hat Certified System Administrator (RHCSA) – RHEL 8
- Red Hat Certified System Administrator (RHCSA) – RHEL 7
- Training: RHCE, VMware, AIX, CyberArk and DevOps

EDUCATION

Master of Technology (M.Tech) – Eswar College of Engineering
 Bachelor of Technology (B.Tech) – Eswar College of Engineering

RECOGNITION

- HCL Jewels Awards: Gold (2) and Silver (4)
- SPOT awards in Virtusa (2)
- Quiz Champion – School Level
- Student of the Batch Momentum – Full Attendance